

45. In whose court was the famous Telugu poet 'Srinath'?

- (a) Harihara Second (b) Dev Raya First
(c) Dev Raya Second (d) Krishnadeva Raya

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The Telugu Poet Srinath (1365-1441 AD) was in the court of Deva Raya-II, who was the ruler of the Vijayanagara Empire. He was also under the court of Pedakomati Vema Reddy, the Reddy ruler of Kondavidu. CGPSC has deleted this question in its revised answer key.

46. Building Kalyana Mandapas' was a notable feature in the temple construction in the kingdom of –

- (a) Chalukya (b) Chandela
(c) Rashtrakuta (d) Vijayanagara

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Kalyana Mandapas, meant to celebrate divine weddings, was a notable feature of the Vijayanagara Kingdom.

47. Where is the famous Vijaya Vitthal Temple, having its 56 carved pillars emitting musical notes located?

- (a) Belur (b) Bhadrachalam
(c) Hampi (d) Srirangam

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

The Vitthal temple (Shree Vijaya Vitthal Temple) was built by the king of Tuluva Dynasty Krishnadeva Raya (1509-29AD). One of the notable features of the Vitthal temple is its musical pillars. This temple is situated in Hampi. Hampi was the ancient capital of Vijayanagara Empire.

48. Which South Indian dance tradition was first developed during the time of Vijaynagara?

- (a) Mohiniattam (b) Yakshagaan
(c) Krishnaattam (d) Bharatanatyam

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

During the Vijayanagara period, Yakshagaan dance tradition was developed for first time. Yakshagaan is mainly a traditional folk dance of Karnataka, which is popular in its coastal district. It is based on mythological and religious stories.

Delhi Sultanate: Administration

*Sultans of the **Slave Dynasty** ruled from 1206 to 1290 AD.

***Khalji Dynasty** ruled from 1290 to 1320 AD. *The rulers of the **Tughluq Dynasty** ruled from 1320 to 1412 AD. Sayyid Dynasty ruled from 1414 to 1451 AD. *The rulers of **Lodi Dynasty** ruled from 1451 to 1526 AD. During Sultanate period, rule of Tughluq dynasty was the longest. *Most of the

Sultans and Amirs were Turks. *Sultan was the head of central government. Similarly, during the Sultanate Period, those often employed in all the influential positions were called the Amir. These Amirs had a great effect when the Sultan was ineligible and weak or under-age.

*Administrative departments and the rulers who started these departments are as follows –

***Diwan-i-Mustakhraj** (Department of Revenue) - Alauddin Khalji

***Diwan-i-Riyasat** (Department of Market Control) - Alauddin Khalji

***Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi** (Agriculture Department) - Muhammad- Bin Tughluq

***Diwan-i-Khairat** (Charity Department) - Firuz Tughluq

***Diwan-i-Bandagan** - Firuz Tughluq

***Diwan-i-Arz** was related to Army Department

***Diwan-i-Risalat** was related to religious issues and to overseeing foreign affairs.

***Diwan-i-Insha** was related to Government Correspondence

***Diwan-i-Wizarat** was related to financial matters/revenue department.

Wizarat was an institute recognized by the Islamic Constitution. During the reign of Mahmud Ghazni, Abbas Fazal - Bin-Ahmad, who was skilled in governing the administration, became the first wazir. *The prime minister of the state was called **Wazir**. *Wazir was mainly the chief of revenue department (**Diwan-i-Wizarat**). From this point of view, he used to take care of Lagaan, tax system, donations and, military expenditures etc. *Tughluq period was the golden period of Indian Muslim Wizarat. At the time of Firuz Tughluq, the post of the Wazir reached its peak position.

*Army organization and the division of posts were done on the basis of the decimal system. *The head of the troop of the horsemen was called '**Sarkhel**'. *There was a '**Sipahsalar**' above ten Sarkhels, one '**Amir**' above ten Sipahsalar, one '**Malik**' above ten Amirs and one '**Khan**' over ten Maliks. *Sultan was the Chief Commander of the army. *Firuz Tughluq levied taxes, keeping the laws of the Quran in mind. *He permitted four taxes approved in the Quran - **Kharaj**, **Jizya**, **Khums** and **Zakat**. Khums was the looted money. *In the war, the enemies of the state were looted by his people. **4/5 part** of this loot was distributed among the soldiers, and the remaining **1/5** was deposited in the treasury, but Alauddin Khalji and Muhammad Tughluq kept 4/5 in the treasury, and the remaining 1/5 was divided among the soldiers. In the Sultanate period, the smallest unit of governance was village, which was under the arrangement of self-government and paternal authority. ***Chaudhary** was the highest official of land revenue at the village level.

*The Sultanate period had two major currencies - **Jital** and **Tanka**. *Iltutmish was the first Turk ruler, who introduced pure Arabic coins. *He introduced the two main coins namely Tanka of silver, and Jital of copper. *The ratio of Tanka and Jital was **1: 48**. *The name of the last Khalifa of Baghdad was first mentioned on the coin of Alauddin Masood Shah (1242 - 46 AD). * The last Khalifa of Baghdad was Khalifa-al-Mustasim (1242 - 58 AD). The name of **Khalifa-al-Mustansir** was mentioned on coins of Iltutmish. Hadees was an Islamic law, while the Jawabit was related to state law.

1. The historian Barani did not consider the state in India under Delhi Sultans as truly Islamic because :

- (a) The majority of the population did not follow Islam
- (b) The Muslim theologists were often disregarded
- (c) The Sultan supplemented the Muslim law by framing his regulations
- (d) The religious freedom was accorded to non-Muslims

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

Historian Barani refused to consider the state in India under Delhi sultans as truly Islamic because the majority of the population did not follow Islam.

2. Most of the rulers (amirs) and sultans of Sultanate period belonged to the class

- (a) Turkish
- (b) Mongols
- (c) Tatars
- (d) Arabs

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

Most of the rulers and sultans of Sultanate age were from Turkish class. Sultan was the chief of the central authority. Thus, persons appointed on powerful designations were referred 'Amir' in Sultanate age. Their impact emerged strongly when Sultan was unworthy, weak or infant.

3. Consider the following statements:

- 1. In the revenue administration of Delhi Sultanate, the in-charge of revenue collection was known as 'Amil'.**
- 2. The Iqta system of Sultans of Delhi was an ancient indigenous institution.**
- 3. The office of 'Mir Bakshi' came into existence during the reign of Khalji Sultans of Delhi.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The province was divided into Parganas or Kasbas. The government official of a Pargana was Amil, who collected revenues. The Mushrif kept accounts at the Pargana level and the Khazandar was in charge of the treasury.

Iqta was not indigenous.

Mir Bakshi headed military department, nobility, information & intelligence agencies during Mughal Administration.

4. Which one of the following is NOT the characteristic of 'Iqta System'?

- (a) Iqta was a revenue collection system
- (b) Siyasatnama was the source of information for Iqta system
- (c) Revenue from Iqta was directly deposited in Sultan's account
- (d) Muqti was supported to maintain troops out of the revenue collected from Iqta

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Iqta system in India was introduced by Iltutmish during Sultanate period. According to this system, the owner of Iqta (Iqtadar or Muqti) was given the responsibility of collecting revenue and taxes in his area. Revenue from Iqta was not directly deposited in Sultan's account, whereas it was used by the Muqti to meet his administrative and military expenditures. Muqti had to maintain troops out of this revenue collected from Iqta for the service of Sultan. Siyasatnama authored by Abu Ali Hasan Ibn Ali Tusi (Nizam-ul-Mulk) is the source of information for primary Iqta system.

5. With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

- (a) Paragana – Sarkar – Suba
- (b) Sarkar – Paragana – Suba
- (c) Suba – Sarkar – Paragana
- (d) Paragana – Suba – Sarkar

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

With reference to medieval India, entire empire was divided into Suba (province). 'Subedar' was head of administration of Suba. For better administration, every Suba was divided into smaller units called Sarkar whose head was 'Fauzdar'. Every Sarkar was further divided into 'Pargana' or 'Mahal'. Shiqdar was head of this unit. There were villages under Pargana, which were called 'Mavada' or 'Deeha'. 'Nagla' were small colonies under Mavada. During the reign of Shahjahan another unit was formed between Pargana and Sarkar called 'Chakla' under which a few Parganas came. Hence with reference to medieval India, the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size is – Pargana-Sarkar-Suba.

6. Who created the department of Diwan-i-Arz in Delhi Sultanate?

- (a) Balban (b) Iltutmish
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Firuz Tughluq

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Balban (1266-1286 A.D.) was undoubtedly one of the main architects of the Delhi Sultanate, particularly of its form of government and institutions. He separated Diwan-i-wizarat (Finance Department) and created a new Department Diwan-i-Arz (Military Department). He then reorganised the Diwan-i-Arz and deployed the army in different parts of the kingdom to put down the rebellion.

7. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched:

- (a) Diwan-i-Mushtakharaj - Alauddin Khalji
(b) Diwan-i-Amir Kohi - Muhammad Bin Tughluq
(c) Diwan-i-Khairat - Firuz Tughluq
(d) Diwan-i-Riyasat - Balban

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

Rulers who established new administrative departments mentioned in the options are as follows –

Diwan-i-Mushtakharaj	- Alauddin Khalji (Revenue Department)
Diwan-i-Amir-i- Kohi	- Muhammad-Bin Tughluq (Agriculture Department)
Diwan-i-Khairat	- Firuz Tughluq (Department of Charity)
Diwan-i-Riyasat	- Alauddin Khalji (Market Control Department)

8. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Diwan-i-Bandagan - Firuz Shah Tughluq
(b) Diwan-i-Mustakhraj - Balban
(c) Diwan -i-Kohi - Alauddin Khalji
(d) Diwan-i-Arz - Muhammad Tughluq

I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Diwan-i-Bandagan was established by Firuz Shah Tughluq. This department dealt with slaves. A new department Diwan-i- Mustakharaj was established by Alauddin Khalji to deal with corruption and loot from the revenue system. Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq created department 'Diwan-i-Amir-i- Kohi' for agrarian development. Diwan-i-Arz (Military Department) was created by Balban.

9. During Sultanate period, 'Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi' was related with which of the following?

- (a) Army (b) Revenue

(c) Agriculture

(d) Entertainment

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

Muhammad bin Tughlaq introduced the department of Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi for the development of Agriculture. The purpose of the department was to provide direct aid to farmers so as to bring more land under agriculture.

10. Which ruler established 'Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi' department?

- (a) Balban
(b) Allauddin Khilji
(c) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq
(d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

11. Match List-I and List-II and choose your answer from the codes given below:

List-I

List-II

- A. Diwan-i-Arz 1. Dealt with religious matters
B. Diwan-i-Risalat 2. Dealt with state's correspondence
C. Diwan-i-Insha 3. Dealt with Finance Dept
D. Diwan-i-Wizarat 4. Dealt with Military Dept

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	4	2
(b)	2	4	1	3
(c)	3	2	1	4
(d)	4	1	2	3

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched departments and their activities are as follows :

Diwan-i- Arz	-	Dealt with Military department
Diwan-i-Risalat	-	Dealt with religious issues/ matters/related to foreign matters.
Diwan-i-Insha	-	Dealt with State correspondence
Diwan-i-Wizarat	-	Dealt with financial matters

12. 'Diwan-i-Arj' department was associated with:

- (a) Royal correspondence (b) Foreign
(c) Defence (d) Finance
(e) None of the above / more than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. Which one of the following dynasties saw the heyday of the Wizarat:

- (a) The Ilbari (b) The Khalji
(c) The Tughluq (d) The Lodi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Wizarat was an institution recognized by the Islamic constitution. Non-Arabic institutions were being repealed, and nomenclature used for Minister for Council under emperor was used as Wizarat. The idea for adopting Wizarat as an institution was inspired by Persia by Abbasi Caliphs. Abbas Fazal-Bin-Ahmad was first Wazir in the reign of Mahmud Ghaznavi, who was accomplished in conducting the administration. The prime minister of state was known as Wazir. He headed the finance department called the Diwan-i-Wizarat and had the power not only to supervise the income and expenditure of the state but other departments as well. Tughluq era was the golden period of Indian Muslim Wizarat.

14. Government of medieval period was a composite structure. It was a fusion of :

- (a) Perso-Arabic
(b) Turko-Mongol (Central Asian)
(c) Perso-Arabic, Turko-Mongol (Central Asian)
(d) Perso-Arabic, Turko-Mongol – Indian Elements

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Government of medieval period was a composite structure of Perso-Arabic, Turko-Mongol and Indian elements.

15. Which of the following indicates taxes levied on the land product?

- i. Kharaj ii. Khums
iii. Ushr iv. Muktai
Select your answer from the following codes –
(a) only i (b) ii and iii
(c) i, ii and iii (d) I, iii, and iv

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

In Islamic traditions, Khums refers to the historically required religious delegation of the Muslim army to pay one-fifth of the spoils of war, the booty collected from non-believers after a military campaign. This tax was paid to the Caliph or Sultan, representing the state of Islam. Rest of the other are taxes levied on the land product.

16. Which medieval king of India introduced the 'Iqta system'?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) None of these

U. P. P. C. S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Iltutmish first introduced 'Iqta' system in Delhi Sultanate Period. In the Islamic empire of the Caliph, land was granted to army officials for limited periods in lieu of a regular wage. The Iqta system was introduced in the 9th century A.D. to relieve the state treasury when insufficient tax revenue and little booty from wars made it difficult for the government to pay salaries.

17. During the Delhi Sultanate, the designation 'Muqaddam or Chaudhari' was used for

- (a) Village headman
(b) Revenue officials
(c) Village accountant
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

'Muqaddam or Chaudhari' were village headman and in this capacity only was the highest revenue authority in the village and not just any revenue official or village accountant.

18. During the Delhi Sultanate, the designation 'Muqaddam or Chaudhuri' was used for

- (a) Village headmen
(b) Village accountant
(c) Revenue officials
(d) None of the above

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

19. Supreme rural officials of land revenue in Sultanate period?

- (a) Chaudhary (b) Ravat
(c) Malik (d) Patwari

I.A.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

During the Sultanate period, Chaudhary played an important role in the traditional social structure. If we delineate traditional social structure, it will have at its top the Sultan followed by Sultan's governors, a village headman who happened to be Chaudhary. At the time of the revolt, Sultanate started eliminating the influence of Rais and sought the help of Chaudhary to collect revenue. Hence, Chaudhary was the main revenue collector for villages during the Sultanate period.

20. 'Sharb' was a tax levied on:

- (a) Trade (b) Irrigation
(c) Non-Muslims (d) Industry

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Firuz Tughluq determined taxation according to Quran rules. He permitted four taxes approved by Quran: (1) Kharaj (2) Jizya (3) Khums (4) Zakat. He levied irrigation tax 'Haqq-e-sharb' at 10% rate of the crop yield on recommendations of religious scholars. Firuz Tughluq abolished 21 grievous taxes of his time.

21. Zawabits were concerned with :

- (a) State laws
- (b) Law regulating mansab system
- (c) Laws regulating mint house
- (d) Agricultural taxes

**U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1997
39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994**

Ans. (a)

Zawabits were related to state laws in the administrative vocabulary of the Sultanate period.

22. Hadis is –

- (a) Islamic Law
- (b) Settlement Law
- (c) Tax of Sultanate period
- (d) Mansabdar
- (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

The Hadis (or Hadith) is the collection of biographic reports about the sayings, customs and doings of Muhammad and his companions. They also reflect on what Muhammad enjoined and tolerated in his presence or forbade.

23. Who was 'Khareetadar'?

- (a) Chief Officer of Pargana
- (b) Main custodian of royal palace
- (c) An officer who was trained in keeping accounts
- (d) Despatcher of royal decrees

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Khareetadar was a despatcher of royal decrees.

24. Fawazil in the Sultanate period meant :

- (a) Extra payment to the nobles
- (b) Revenue assigned in lieu of salary
- (c) Excess amount paid to the exchequer by the Iqtadars
- (d) Illegal exactions extracted from the peasants

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

During the Sultanate period, the excess amount paid to the exchequer by Iqtadar was called 'Fawazil'.

25. Find out the two main currencies of the Sultanate period from the code given below :

- 1. Dam
- 2. Jital
- 3. Rupiya
- 4. Tanka

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 1 and 3
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 2 and 4

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The two main currencies of the Sultanate period are Jital and Tanka. Iltutmish was the first Turkish ruler who started the pure Arabian coins. He had a great contribution to the currency system of Delhi Sultanate as he was the first ruler who started the famous coins of silver (Tanka) and copper (Jital).

26. Who among the following started 'Tanka' silver coin?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Balban

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

27. Who was the medieval king responsible for introducing the silver coin called 'Tanka' in North India?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Raziyya
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Muhammad Tughluq

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

28. Coins-Tanka, Shashgani and Jital of Sultanate period was made of which of the following metals-

- (a) Silver, Copper
- (b) Gold, Silver, Copper
- (c) Silver, Zink, Copper
- (d) Gold, Zink, Copper

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Iltutmish was the first to issue regular currency and declare Delhi as the capital of his empire. He started the 'Tanka' and the 'Jital' coins, made up of silver and copper, respectively, in the Sultanate period. Shashgani was also a silver coin. The ratio of Tanka and Jital was 1:48.

29. On whose coins the name of the last Caliph of Baghdad appeared for the first time?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Alauddin Masud Shah

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

On the coins of Alauddin Masud Shah (1242-1246 A.D.), the name of the last Caliph of Baghdad appeared for the first time. The last Caliph of Baghdad was Al-Mustasim. He held this position from 1242-58 A.D. The name of Caliph Mustanasir was inscribed on the coins of Iltutmish (served from 1226 to 1242 A.D.)